NCE EXAM PREP

Practice Exam 05

Domain 5

Indirect Client Care

21 Practice Questions | 28 minutes

A, B, C answer choices

Answer Key and Explanations included

> **Instructions.** Select the single best answer for each question. Record your answers separately. This domain practice set is drawn from Full-Length Practice Exam 01. Use the suggested 28-minute practice timer. Do not consult Part B until you complete Part A. These domain timings are editorial practice allocations, not official NBCC section limits.

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PART A — QUESTIONS

Choose one answer (A, B, or C) per question.

Question 1

Which practice is most likely to keep a counseling program's referral directory usable?

A) Add every known local agency once and preserve the original entry dates for consistency

B) Regularly verify eligibility, services, accessibility, languages, costs, wait times, and contact routes

C) Rank programs only by public online reviews so clients can receive the most popular options

Question 2

Which case-note statement most clearly distinguishes client report from counselor observation?

A) The client appeared severely depressed and probably skipped work throughout the week.

B) The client was evasive about employment and unwilling to improve the situation.

C) The client reported missing three shifts; the counselor observed slowed speech and tearfulness during the discussion.

Question 3

> Devon receives services at a community agency and uses an augmentative communication device after a traumatic brain injury. The prior session note states that extended open-ended questioning caused fatigue and that Devon preferred a brief written rating scale with additional response time. The next session will continue work on Devon's goal of increasing independent community activities.

What is the most appropriate way for the counselor to prepare for the session?

A) Prepare the rating scale, allow additional response time, and review the prior goal and fatigue pattern

B) Plan the same interview format used with all clients so Devon is not treated differently

C) Ask Devon's caregiver to answer the questions in advance because Devon's responses take longer

Question 4

> Nia receives telehealth counseling for chronic pain and depression. The prior note indicates that she agreed to track sleep, a routine outcome measure increased modestly, and the session revealed no acute safety concern.

What should the counselor do while preparing for Nia's next session?

A) Draft a note describing worsening depression so the session can focus on treatment changes

B) Review the prior goal, sleep-tracking plan, measure change, and questions needed to clarify what changed

C) Omit the outcome measure from preparation because the prior session revealed no crisis

Question 5

A progress note states, "Family reports frequent anger." The counselor later learns that only the client's brother made the statement and that the client disagreed. Which documentation action best supports accurate continuity of care?

A) Add a dated clarification attributing the statement to the brother and noting the client's disagreement

B) Replace the original sentence with "The client has anger problems" so future clinicians recognize the issue

C) Delete the statement entirely because the available accounts conflict

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Question 6

> During a school counseling session, 15-year-old Sam folded their arms and was silent for about two minutes after discussing a schedule change. Sam then said, "I'm angry because nobody listened to me."

Which note entry is most accurate and neutral?

A) Sam was oppositional and refused to cooperate because of the schedule change.

B) Sam displayed conduct problems that require disciplinary intervention.

C) Sam folded their arms and was silent for about two minutes, then reported feeling angry and ignored after the schedule change.

Question 7

> A Deaf client who primarily communicates in American Sign Language schedules an intake at a community counseling clinic. The client's spouse offers to interpret, although the client has not requested the spouse's help.

What should the counselor arrange before the intake?

A) A qualified behavioral health ASL interpreter, while asking the client about the preferred communication setup

B) Interpretation by the spouse because the spouse already knows the client's history

C) Written communication only because it avoids involving another person in the session

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Question 8

> A 19-year-old client leaving foster care has authorized a wraparound meeting with a housing navigator and an employment coach. The client wants to keep a new job but has repeatedly missed shifts because evening bus service ends too early.

Which approach would make the meeting most useful?

A) Allow the providers to exchange all available information so they can design a comprehensive plan

B) Center the client's employment goal, share the relevant transportation barrier, and define each participant's follow-up role

C) Limit the meeting to a summary of symptoms because nonclinical providers should not discuss practical barriers

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Question 9

> Marisol, a university counseling center client, experiences panic symptoms while commuting and in crowded lecture halls. She has authorized the counselor in writing to coordinate with a disability access consultant and her academic advisor. Her stated goal is to attend required laboratory sessions consistently.

Which information should the counselor prepare to communicate at the coordination meeting?

A) Marisol's full diagnostic intake so the stakeholders can independently determine accommodations

B) A summary of functional barriers, current coping supports, and Marisol's stated attendance goal within the authorization

C) A request that the stakeholders recommend a new counseling goal before hearing Marisol's preferences

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Question 10

> Aisha, a community agency client facing eviction, has authorized coordination with a school family liaison, a housing advocate, and a food-support program. At a meeting, the team discovers that two members started duplicate benefit applications and no one is helping Aisha assemble the documents requested by the landlord.

What should the counselor facilitate next?

A) Confirm Aisha's priorities, assign nonduplicative responsibilities and deadlines, and document the follow-up plan

B) Ask every team member to handle all applications independently to maximize the chance of success

C) Have the school liaison choose the plan because that professional has the most frequent contact with the family

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Question 11

> Before a college counseling session, a counselor reviews a newly completed outcome measure showing lower anxiety. The prior note says the client expected anxiety to worsen before an upcoming class presentation.

How should the counselor use the apparently different information?

A) Assume the client has improved and cancel further review of presentation-related anxiety

B) Bring both data points into the session, ask about their context, and use the clarification to guide and document the current assessment

C) Revise the prior note so it agrees with the more recent outcome-measure score

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Question 12

> Four days after a psychiatric nurse practitioner increased Leila's medication, Leila tells her counselor that she feels light-headed and has trouble concentrating. She reports no falls or other emergency symptoms, and the counselor observes a steady gait. A current written authorization permits coordination with the prescriber.

How should the counselor handle this information?

A) Recommend that Leila return to the previous dose until her next appointment

B) Record "medication intolerance" as the counselor's conclusion and continue routine sessions

C) Document the timing and effects as Leila reported them and contact the prescriber to relay the concern

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Question 13

When arranging translation of a written counseling resource into a client's preferred language, which approach best supports accurate access?

A) Ask a bilingual staff member in an unrelated role to translate informally and assume the client's literacy level

B) Use a qualified translator, preserve the meaning in plain language, and provide a way to ask questions through qualified language support

C) Rely on machine translation without review so the resource can be delivered as quickly as possible

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Question 14

> Priya, an uninsured community mental health client, is seeking outpatient eating-disorder care and has transportation only on Saturdays. A directory entry from nine months ago lists a program as offering sliding-scale weekend appointments, but the counselor has not recently confirmed the information. Priya reports no acute medical or safety concern.

What should the counselor do before recommending the program?

A) Send Priya to the program based on the existing directory entry so the referral is not delayed

B) Refer Priya directly to inpatient care because access barriers make outpatient treatment unsuitable

C) Verify current eligibility, fees, scheduling, and accessibility without disclosing Priya's identity, then review the options and next steps with her

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Question 15

> Omar lives in a rural area and seeks trauma-focused counseling with evening availability. He is uninsured, has limited transportation, and cannot rely on the public library's internet connection. The counselor's recently verified directory includes a mobile clinic and a low-bandwidth telehealth program.

What is the best next step in making a referral?

A) Review the eligibility and access tradeoffs with Omar, then offer a warm connection to his preferred verified service

B) Select the program with the strongest clinical reputation regardless of its hours, cost, or access requirements

C) Give Omar the complete directory and ask him to call programs until one accepts him

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Question 16

> Eli brings two bottles of the same antidepressant in different strengths to a counseling appointment and says he alternates them "depending on the day." He reports no acute symptoms. The counselor cannot verify the current prescription, but a written authorization permits contact with the prescriber.

What should the counselor do?

A) Choose the newer bottle and instruct Eli to discard the older medication

B) Advise Eli to continue his current pattern until the next scheduled prescriber visit

C) Record Eli's exact report and the bottle labels, encourage prompt clarification from the prescriber or pharmacist, and coordinate under the authorization

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Question 17

> Janelle wants to return to work after cancer treatment and has authorized collaboration with a vocational rehabilitation specialist. The specialist recommends an immediate full-time return, while Janelle tells the counselor that a graded schedule feels sustainable.

How should the counselor contribute to coordination?

A) Endorse the specialist's plan because vocational decisions should be determined by the specialist

B) Communicate Janelle's stated pacing goal and facilitate a plan that addresses functional information and available supports

C) Withhold Janelle's preference so the specialist can make an unbiased recommendation

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Question 18

> Mr. Chen, an older adult receiving grief counseling, has authorized his daughter to coordinate transportation and appointment times only. His daughter calls to arrange a ride and asks whether he talks about his grief during sessions.

How should the counselor respond?

A) Coordinate the ride details only and invite Mr. Chen to decide whether he wants to expand the information-sharing scope

B) Confirm whether grief is discussed but avoid giving any details about what Mr. Chen says

C) Send the daughter the latest note because her transportation support makes her part of the care team

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Question 19

> In an integrated care clinic, a client with depression and diabetes has authorized the counselor to coordinate with the primary care provider. The provider asks whether the client is "compliant." The client set a goal of walking for 10 minutes three days per week and completed five of the six planned walks during the past two weeks, while reporting that foot pain was the main barrier.

What is the counselor's best response to the provider?

A) Share the concrete behavioral progress, the reported barrier, and the client's stated goal without using a global label

B) Describe the client as noncompliant because the walking plan was not completed exactly as prescribed

C) Send the full psychotherapy note so the provider can decide how motivated the client is

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Question 20

> An adult client returning to the community after incarceration has authorized coordination with a housing coordinator and a workforce coach. The client has a promising job interview in six days but lacks the identification documents required for hiring.

Which coordination step best supports the client's immediate goal?

A) Tell the prospective employer about the client's history so the employer can prepare for possible delays

B) Reserve the next counseling session for emotional reactions because document replacement is outside counseling

C) Arrange a warm handoff to an identification-replacement resource and align the coordinator's and coach's tasks with the interview timeline

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Question 21

> A counselor is preparing to meet a transferred client. The most recent notes use the client's chosen name, Luca, and they/them pronouns, while an older intake form lists a different name and pronouns. The transfer summary identifies current goals but does not explain the discrepancy.

How should the counselor prepare for the first session?

A) Copy the older demographic information into the agenda because the original intake is authoritative

B) Avoid using any name or pronouns unless the client raises the subject first

C) Use the latest client-stated information, note the discrepancy for respectful confirmation, and review the current goals

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PART B — ANSWER KEY AND EXPLANATIONS

Answers match the numbered items in Part A.

Question 1 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Regularly verify eligibility, services, accessibility, languages, costs, wait times, and contact routes

Explanation: A referral directory is useful only when its entries reflect the practical conditions clients will encounter. Regular verification reduces failed referrals caused by changed eligibility, capacity, cost, or access. Popularity ratings do not establish fit or current availability.

Question 2 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: The client reported missing three shifts; the counselor observed slowed speech and tearfulness during the discussion.

Explanation: This statement identifies the source of the employment information and separately records behaviors the counselor directly observed. The other statements add unsupported conclusions about severity, motivation, or events outside the session. Neutral attribution makes the record more useful to later providers.

Question 3 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Prepare the rating scale, allow additional response time, and review the prior goal and fatigue pattern

Explanation: Reviewing the prior note allows the counselor to prepare an accessible format that Devon has already identified as useful. This preserves Devon's participation and connects the session to the established goal. Having a caregiver answer instead would unnecessarily replace Devon's voice.

Question 4 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Review the prior goal, sleep-tracking plan, measure change, and questions needed to clarify what changed

Explanation: Good preparation integrates the prior plan and the new measure without assuming what the score change means. Clarifying questions can identify whether pain, sleep, mood, or another context influenced the result. Drafting a conclusion before speaking with Nia would turn preliminary data into an unsupported judgment.

Question 5 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Add a dated clarification attributing the statement to the brother and noting the client's disagreement

Explanation: The clarification corrects the ambiguity by identifying who supplied the information and preserving the client's differing account. This gives later readers a more accurate basis for clinical judgment without converting a disputed report into fact. Deleting the information would remove potentially relevant context rather than clarify it.

Question 6 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Sam folded their arms and was silent for about two minutes, then reported feeling angry and ignored after the schedule change.

Explanation: The correct entry records observable behavior, approximate duration, and Sam's own account without assigning a diagnosis or motive. The other choices convert a brief response into pejorative or unsupported conclusions. Neutral detail allows later readers to interpret the event in context.

Question 7 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: A qualified behavioral health ASL interpreter, while asking the client about the preferred communication setup

Explanation: Qualified interpretation supports accurate, direct communication while preserving the client's role in choosing how services are delivered. A spouse may introduce role conflicts, filtering, or inhibited disclosure and should not be assumed to be the client's preferred interpreter. Written communication alone is not an equivalent substitute unless the client selects it as appropriate.

Question 8 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Center the client's employment goal, share the relevant transportation barrier, and define each participant's follow-up role

Explanation: A focused wraparound meeting should organize stakeholders around the client's stated outcome and the concrete barrier affecting it. Clear roles reduce duplication and make follow-through more likely. Exchanging all available information is broader than necessary and does not itself create an actionable plan.

Question 9 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: A summary of functional barriers, current coping supports, and Marisol's stated attendance goal within the authorization

Explanation: Effective coordination shares information that is relevant to the client's goal and permitted by the authorization. Functional barriers and current supports can help the stakeholders plan access without exposing unrelated clinical history. Sending the full intake would disclose more information than the meeting requires.

Question 10 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Confirm Aisha's priorities, assign nonduplicative responsibilities and deadlines, and document the follow-up plan

Explanation: The team needs a client-centered division of labor that closes the identified gap and prevents further duplication. Named responsibilities and deadlines make follow-through observable across organizations. Having everyone repeat the same tasks wastes effort and still leaves the landlord-document need unassigned.

Question 11 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Bring both data points into the session, ask about their context, and use the clarification to guide and document the current assessment

Explanation: A measure score and an earlier expectation can both be accurate within different time frames or contexts. Preparing to explore the discrepancy avoids prematurely labeling it and supports an updated assessment based on the client's explanation. Altering the prior note would erase what was known at that earlier time.

Question 12 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Document the timing and effects as Leila reported them and contact the prescriber to relay the concern

Explanation: The counselor should accurately attribute the possible medication effects to Leila and communicate the concern to the prescriber under the existing authorization. The prescriber can assess whether the medication contributed and determine any change. Recommending a dose reduction would exceed the counselor's role.

Question 13 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Use a qualified translator, preserve the meaning in plain language, and provide a way to ask questions through qualified language support

Explanation: Qualified translation and a supported question process address both the written resource's accuracy and the client's ability to understand and use it. Bilingual ability alone does not establish skill in translating counseling content. Unreviewed machine output may distort clinically important meaning.

Question 14 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Verify current eligibility, fees, scheduling, and accessibility without disclosing Priya's identity, then review the options and next steps with her

Explanation: Nine-month-old access information may no longer be reliable, and Priya's schedule and financial constraints are central to referral fit. Verifying program details without client-identifying information reduces the risk of a failed referral and preserves Priya's choice. Nothing in the scenario supports changing the level of care to inpatient treatment.

Question 15 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Review the eligibility and access tradeoffs with Omar, then offer a warm connection to his preferred verified service

Explanation: A sound referral accounts for clinical fit and the client's real access constraints while preserving client choice. Both verified resources may be viable, so discussing tradeoffs and facilitating contact is more useful than simply supplying names. Reputation alone does not overcome incompatible hours, cost, transportation, or technology.

Question 16 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Record Eli's exact report and the bottle labels, encourage prompt clarification from the prescriber or pharmacist, and coordinate under the authorization

Explanation: The counselor can document the discrepancy, support timely clarification, and relay relevant information without deciding which dose is correct. The prescriber or pharmacist is positioned to reconcile the medication instructions. Selecting a bottle or endorsing the alternating pattern would amount to medication guidance unsupported by verified prescribing information.

Question 17 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Communicate Janelle's stated pacing goal and facilitate a plan that addresses functional information and available supports

Explanation: Collaboration should preserve Janelle's goal while helping the team integrate functional needs and available workplace supports. The specialist's expertise is relevant, but it does not replace the client's stated preference or the need for a coordinated plan. Withholding her preference would make the plan less client-centered and potentially less sustainable.

Question 18 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Coordinate the ride details only and invite Mr. Chen to decide whether he wants to expand the information-sharing scope

Explanation: The existing authorization permits logistical coordination but not discussion of session content. Staying within that scope supports the daughter's practical role while preserving Mr. Chen's control over any broader collaboration. Even confirming that grief is discussed would answer a clinical question outside the stated authorization.

Question 19 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Share the concrete behavioral progress, the reported barrier, and the client's stated goal without using a global label

Explanation: Specific behavioral data and the client's context give the provider usable information for coordinated care. A global term such as "noncompliant" obscures both substantial progress and the foot-pain barrier. The full psychotherapy note would include information unnecessary for the coordination question.

Question 20 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Arrange a warm handoff to an identification-replacement resource and align the coordinator's and coach's tasks with the interview timeline

Explanation: The identification barrier directly threatens the client's near-term employment goal and is well suited to coordinated practical support. A warm handoff and aligned roles improve the likelihood of timely completion. Disclosing incarceration history to an employer is not necessary to solve the document problem.

Question 21 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Use the latest client-stated information, note the discrepancy for respectful confirmation, and review the current goals

Explanation: The most recent client-stated name and pronouns are the best available information for respectful preparation. Flagging the discrepancy allows the counselor to confirm rather than assume while also maintaining continuity on current goals. Treating an older intake as automatically controlling could perpetuate outdated information.
